

Belkin Wireless G Router

For Those Who Need The Space

Belkin's new router is rather compact and is excellent for cramped tables. The router can also be hung up on a wall if required. The design is pretty and the build quality isn't too bad either.

It comes with four ports for clients and one for an Internet connection — standard for a home router.

The user interface is boring, and way too bare for most people's liking. The design doesn't make it very easy to use either. It has all the features expected, including the ones for security. WEP, WPA and WPA2 are all supported, but the interface is painfully slow.

Routing, as expected, is possible too, and a unique feature is the list of application and games along with the list of ports used by them. This means you can

just choose from a list and add to the port forwarding list. Filters can be set up to block access during specified hours or days. Support for DynDNS and DtDNS is also available, which allows the router to automatically update your WAN IP using free DNS services. This allows easy access to your computer or router from other locations. This feature is increasingly popular on routers these days though.

The Belkin Wireless G Router performs well with wired connections, but not so well wirelessly. A gigabyte of data took around two minutes four seconds to

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

download across wires, but the same data took close to seven minutes thirty seconds over the air. Uploading files took a little longer, but we didn't have any latency issues. The router does not support 802.11n, for those who might want it.

Updating of the firmware can be done using the web interface itself.

With everything considered, we can't highly recommend this product because of its price.

At Rs 2,699, it isn't overly expensive, but for a little more you can get much better products with the same (or more) features and a much better interface.

However, if space constraints are your biggest concern, and you want something really small to hang on the wall or keep



on your table, the Belkin Wireless G Router might just be what you're looking for.

Specifications:
Four 10/100 Base-T LAN ports, One WAN port, IEEE 802.11b, 802.11g

Contact: Belkin Asia Pacific Limited
Phone: 9810889785
E-mail: MadhuJ@belkin.com
Web site: www.belkin.com
Price: Rs 2,699

Microsoft Arc

Light And Compact



The unusually designed object you see here is one of the latest pointing devices from Microsoft, and it's called the Arc. The Arc looks something like the Logitech MX Air, but is in fact just another mouse with a different design.

The Arc is a wireless mouse that comes with a tiny little Bluetooth dongle which also attaches itself neatly to the back. The mouse can fold, very much like the foldable phones we see everyday. This both turns off the mouse and also is useful for carrying it around. With it folded, the Arc can easily fit into any shirt or pant pocket. It is also very good looking, with its dark colour and the transparent glossy finish.

There are no issues with using it despite the unusual shape. It has more or less the same comfort levels as any other mouse. Performance doesn't suffer either. There is no lag whatsoever. It makes a good desktop mouse, but the same can't be said as a gaming mouse. The mouse feet aren't very large, and don't seem to help the mouse slide around as easily as the other mice we've tested. The scroll wheel is OK, and apart from the standard three button setup, a fourth button is available on the left side that can be customised through the IntelliPoint drivers.

The mouse runs on two AA batteries, but is still pretty lightweight. The folding mechanism is sturdy and doesn't look like it will give way anytime soon. The mouse is symet-

rical, so left-handed users will have no cause for complaint. A small pouch is also supplied, to help you carry the mouse.

The price for the Arc is Rs 3,283, and laptop mice can be bought for well under this price tag. If you want something light and compact, with a stylish design, this is a good buy.

Specifications:
30 feet range, foldable.

Contact: Microsoft Hardware
Phone: 9886328580
E-mail: geethakb@microsoft.com
Web site: www.microsoft.com/india/edd/
Price: Rs 3,283

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Kingston DataTraveler 400 16GB

Loads Of Space For Cheap

With prices of flash drives dropping drastically, higher capacity drives are flooding the market at prices that are previously unheard of.

Kingston's new 16 GB drive is one of the largest, flash drives we tested this month.

In design, the DT400 is of the same size and format as most other flash drives. It comes with a swinging protection plate suspended on a hinge. This adds to the stur-

diness of the drive and also gives it a nice look.

Password protection in the drive takes care of any security concerns, and performance is not an issue as well. It performs superbly in the sequential file tests. On an average, we

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★



got data transfer rates of between 25 and 30 MBps. Write speeds are slower as expected. HD Tach showed average write speeds of around 10 MBps, which is still quite impressive as compared to other drives of this capacity.

A software called Migosync comes bundled with the drive, and allows you to synchronize files. At Rs 3,999, this drive makes

good sense for those who are looking for good performance within a good budget.

Specifications:
Enhanced for Windows Readyboost, Password protection, File-syncing software included.

Contact: Kingston Technology
Phone: 022-26592961
E-mail: vishal_parekh@kingston.com
Web site: www.kingston.com/india
Price: Rs 3,999

A-DATA S701 Sport Series S701 2 GB

Sporty And Zippy

The A-DATA Sport series of products comes with unique designs and we got one of their 2 GB drives. The S701 sports a rough and modern design. The drive is very compact, has a rough texture with a metal border around it. The drive's socket doesn't have a metal border surround it, and this is a bit of a weak point.

It isn't an excellent performer from the scores we

recorded. SiSoft Sandra recorded data read rates of around 19 MBps, and around 4.2 MBps write speeds. HD Tach scores didn't differ a lot either. Reading a GB of data took around 1 min 16 seconds. Writing a 1 GB file took around 3 minutes. HD Tach showed CPU utilisation of 6 per cent, which is a bit high.

At a price of Rs 550, you might find the actual prices

to be a little lower, which is a good buy.

Specifications
Capacity: 2 GB, Windows ReadyBoost ready, Dimensions: 3.8 x 2.26 x 0.8 cm, Weight: 10 g

Contact: BAK Technology Co. Ltd
Phone: 080-41654050
E-mail: sales@baktech.com.tw
Web site: www.baktech.com.tw
Price: Rs 550



RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
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Apacer AH225 1GB

Good Looking, But Too Small

Apacer's AH225 1 GB drive is another one of your everyday flash drives. The design of the drive is clean. It has a magnetic cap that clings to the drive when closed. This allows you to attach the drive to a metal surface such as your computer case.

The Apacer drive performed a little slower than the higher capacity 2 GB drive in the read tests of both a single large file and multiple smaller files

totalling to 1 GB. Data read speeds were around 13 to 14 MBps and write speeds showed 3.2 MBps. CPU utilisation was five per cent.

A software called Apacer Compression Explorer is available on their site for download which allows some amount of security and compression for the files put on the drive.

With flash drives getting this cheap, there is little reason to consider any-

thing as small as 1 GB. The 1 GB drive is obviously overpriced at Rs 599, but Apacer's design is unique, and worth considering if you get higher capacity drives.

Specifications
Capacity 1 GB, Dimensions: 5.49 x 2.6 x 1.0 cm, Weight: 13 g

Contact: Apacer Technologies Pvt. Ltd.



RATINGS	
Features	★★★★
Performance	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Phone: 080-41529061
E-mail: shiva_neelangi@apacer.com
Web site: www.apacer.com
Price: Rs 599